

Leandro Laenen

Unreal Engine Technical Artist
focused on optimization, shaders,
Niagara systems and development
pipelines & tools.

- ✉ Leandro@gradientgames.net
- 📍 Genk, Belgium
- 🌐 [My Projects](#)
- 📁 [LinkedIn](#)

Skills

→ Graphics Programming and VFX

Materials, Niagara, HLSL,
Post-Process Shaders

→ Programming and Scripting

Blueprints, C++

→ Pipeline and Tools

UE5 PCG, Blender Geometry Nodes,
Source Control (Perforce, Git)

→ Optimization

Unreal Insights, Performance
Profiling

→ Technical Art Generalist

Hard-Surface 3D Modeling, PBR
Texturing

Languages

Dutch (Native)

English (Fluent)

French (Advanced Listening &
Reading / Elementary Speaking)

Awards

Nominated: Multiplayer Game of the
Year

Belgian Game Awards

[Midnight Mayhem Awards Page](#)

Experience

Gradient Games

Genk, Belgium

Technical Artist / Sole Developer
September 2023 - February 2026

Programmed, designed, and shipped two commercial titles on
Steam, driving 20k+ organic wishlists, managing the full lifecycle
from pre-production to release and post-launch patching.
<https://gradientgames.net/>

Projects

Midnight Mayhem

2024 - 2025

Technical Artist / Developer

- **Solved a deferred rendering pipeline limitation** for shadow-based mechanics by decoupling character visibility from the main shadow pass, engineering a localized 64x64 depth render target system costing only ~0.024ms per light source.
- **Profiled and optimized RAM, VRAM and GPU usage** (draw calls, material complexity, texture budgets) and created Niagara GPU systems to render micro-fauna at near-zero performance cost.
- **Targeted and maintained a 50fps framerate target** to secure official Steam Deck Verification.

[Midnight Mayhem Technical Breakdown Available Online](#)

The Last Explorer

2023 - 2024

Technical Artist / Developer

- **Created PCG tools** to accelerate open world development and iteration.
- **Developed a Gerstner wave water shader** and buoyancy system, blending visual fidelity with real-time technical art constraints.

Technical Breakdowns

• Nordic Island Creation Pipeline

Engineered a pipeline to quickly create nordic islands using
Blender Geometry Nodes, a UE5 complex auto-material and UE5
PCG.

<https://leandrolaenen.com/islandpipeline>

• Flat-Surface 3D Sinkhole With Physics Simulation

Engineered a way of rendering a 3d sinkhole as a flat surface
without render layers, stencils or post processing. The system
also allows for physics such as players falling into the hole.

<https://leandrolaenen.com/sinkhole>